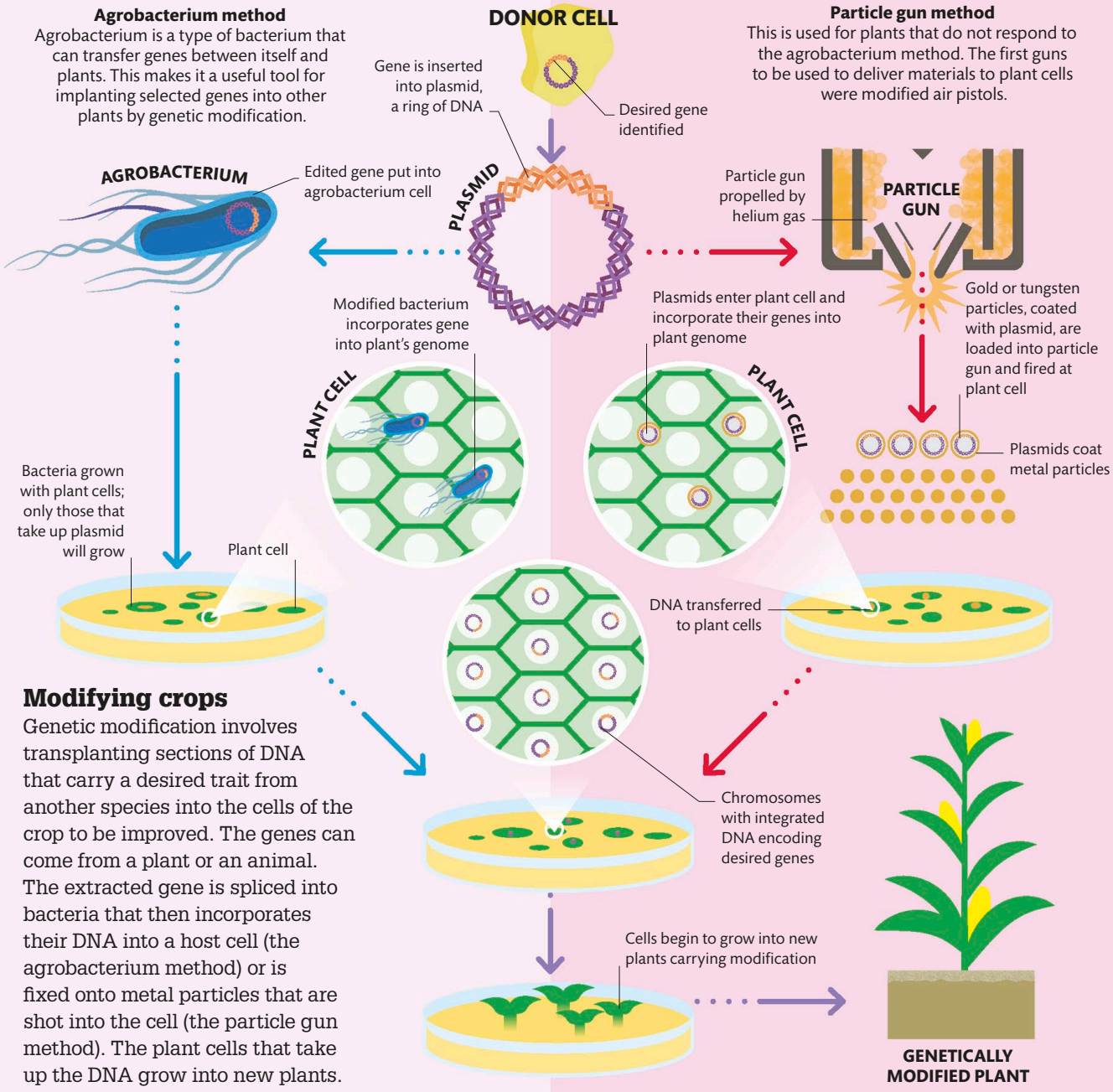
Genetic modification

Genetic modification of crops and animals has made significant inroads into farming. Its use is controversial in many parts of the world, although it is often argued that it is the only way to feed an ever-growing population.



Modifying crops

Genetic modification involves transplanting sections of DNA that carry a desired trait from another species into the cells of the crop to be improved. The genes can come from a plant or an animal. The extracted gene is spliced into bacteria that then incorporates their DNA into a host cell (the agrobacterium method) or is fixed onto metal particles that are shot into the cell (the particle gun method). The plant cells that take up the DNA grow into new plants.